



JEDRZEJ NOWICKI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Frontline Ukrainian schools like this one in Zaporizhzhia, a steel industry town, are better prepared to protect students below ground.

Women Face Rising Threat In Cartel War

By PAULINA VILLEGAS
MAZATLÁN, Mexico — It’s been nearly a year since her younger sister Cecilia disappeared, and Nadia Berrelleza barely sleeps.
Instead, she spends her nights seeking clues, retracing Cecilia’s last movements and scrutinizing messages, photographs and videos claiming to reveal her fate.
One image she received showed a young woman with long, curly black hair — just like Cecilia’s — kneeling and blindfolded, her hands bound, surrounded by armed men. Investigators said the image was generated by A.I. Another video sent on Facebook showed a woman being sexually assaulted. The sender demanded



ADRIANA ZEBRAUSKAS FOR THE N.Y.T.
Nadia Berrelleza’s youngest sister vanished last summer.

a reward.
“I know her face perfectly; I could never have believed it was her,” Ms. Berrelleza said. “But it’s still so horrible to see that.”
Cecilia Berrelleza, 31, went missing in July 2025 after going to lunch with friends in Mazatlán, a coastal city in the Mexican state of Sinaloa. Since then, Nadia has appealed to the authorities and the public, even offering her car in desperation as a reward for Cecilia’s return. The attention, she said, has brought a stream of tips but also opportunists trying to extort her with false claims about Cecilia’s fate.
The disappearance is part of a wave of violence that has made Sinaloa State the most dangerous in the country for women. It also coincides with a war between two factions of the Sinaloa Cartel that has weakened security and ter-

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Ukraine Acclimates to Subterranean Classrooms

By ANDREW E. KRAMER and EVELINA RIABENKO
ZAPORIZHZHIA, Ukraine — On the surface, the schools appear only as playgrounds or soccer fields, with classrooms sunk like bunkers under yards of dirt. Children get a glimpse of the sky only occasionally, when all-clears from air raid alerts allow a bit of time outside.
During the first day of classes on Tuesday in the southern Ukrainian city of Zaporizhzhia, students spent their recess hanging out under ventilation ducts or sitting on benches along the reinforced concrete walls. Little feet swung above the floor.
There are now 74 of these wholly underground schools in Ukraine, a stark measure of the drawn-out nature of the war and of a campaign of Russian aerial

Underground Schools Proliferate as Drones Swarm the Sky

bombardment that is escalating more than four years in.
“It’s impossible to get an education now without going underground,” said Oleksandr Lagin, 39, a grocery store manager whose two sons study below ground for safety against drones and missiles.
It might seem apocalyptic to put children in such schools. But in some ways, they are the lucky ones.
Most of Ukraine’s 3.6 million school-age children study online or above ground. During air alerts, they descend to base-

ments, where students of all ages crowd together and instruction is impossible.
In Kyiv, the capital, on Friday, for example, air alerts were in effect for 158 minutes, or the equivalent of four of six lessons in a school day. The city has been under near-continuous assault from jet-powered drones for days, unnerving parents. On Tuesday, an air alert disrupted opening-day ceremonies there.
The authorities in the Kyiv region urged schools to avoid any ceremonies involving crowds, lest a drone hit them. “Put safety first,” implored Tymur Tkachenko, the regional military administrator.
As Russia continued its barages, eight people were killed overnight on Tuesday in Kyiv, including six employees of a railway company in an attack on train in-

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A Climate Law To Bill Polluters Is Struck Down

By KAREN ZRAICK
A federal judge has struck down New York State’s new climate “superfund” law, ruling that it conflicted with federal law.
The law, signed by Gov. Kathy Hochul in 2024, required large fossil fuel companies to pay \$75 billion over 25 years for projects to bolster the state’s ability to withstand the extreme weather linked to global warming.
The law was modeled on the federal Superfund program to clean up industrial waste, and it inspired several other states to consider similar climate legislation. But Republican-led states, the Trump administration and business groups challenged New York’s law as well as a similar one in Vermont.
Judge Brenda K. Sannes, an Obama appointee and chief judge for the Northern District of New York, ruled on Monday that New York’s “unusual and sweeping statute” was unenforceable. She wrote in the 63-page decision that its ambitions surpassed the limits of state law.
The judge relied heavily on a 2021 decision by the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Second Circuit dismissing a lawsuit by New York City against oil companies that argued that the companies should

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MADELINE HORDINSKI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

In Praise of Peevish Pets
At the largest annual ferret show in the nation, a shrinking community celebrated the animals’ quirks — and its own. Page A11.

Vance Strives To Win Over Jewish Voters

Met With Skepticism at a Key Conference

By YAIR ROSENBERG and THEODORE SCHLEIFER
LAS VEGAS — When Vice President JD Vance’s team was mulling whether to accept an invitation to speak to the Republican Jewish Coalition, intermediaries reached out to a few prominent Jewish donors for a gut check: What type of reception would he get, exactly?
Many Jewish conservatives had major reservations about Mr. Vance that had only escalated in recent months as he became the public face of the administration’s diplomatic efforts with Iran, Israel’s sworn enemy. So his appearance at the group’s biannual conference in Las Vegas, where he would face one of the Republican factions most skeptical of him, his ambitions and associations, would be a risk.
The outreach by Mr. Vance’s allies, described by two people with knowledge of it who were granted anonymity to discuss private communications, reflected a delicate balancing act. An all-but-certain presidential candidate next year, Mr. Vance is trying to hold together a coalition that has been bitterly divided over antisemitism, the place of Jews in American politics, and the U.S.-Israel relationship before the Republican primary contest takes off in earnest next year.
In closed-door remarks on the fifth floor of a Vegas Strip casino, the vice president defended his relationships with divisive influencers, noted parallels between his Catholic faith and Judaism, and called for rewriting the playbook for how Republicans make the case for the U.S.-Israel alliance, according to audio of his question-and-answer session obtained by The Times.
Mr. Vance flew to Las Vegas from Michigan, where he called Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, Michigan’s Democratic Senate nominee and an outspoken critic of Israel, “very, very evil” at a rally for the candidate’s Republican opponent, former Representative Mike Rogers.

The vice president’s stop in Las Vegas was widely understood, including by members of the coalition’s board, as an attempt to smooth things over with an influential community that remains one of the holdouts in the Republican donor class and commentariat. Even before he addressed the group on Monday evening, the tension was palpable in the room.
“I’ve gotten about 100 texts the last two days: ‘Why Vance?’” Sid Rosenberg, a conservative radio

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A BOND SELL-OFF JOLTS BORROWERS ACROSS THE GLOBE

WORRY OVER INFLATION

Iran War Drives Turmoil as Yields Hit Highest Levels in Decades

By ESHE NELSON
LONDON — A global sell-off in government bonds intensified on Tuesday, pushing borrowing costs in some of the world’s largest economies to the highest levels in decades. The moves threaten to ripple through a wide range of debt, including business loans and mortgages for already-stretched consumers.
A combination of factors is prompting investors to demand higher returns to hold government debt: a flood of borrowing by the world’s richest nations, expanding budget deficits, persistent inflation and few signs that countries are able or willing to take steps to improve these conditions.
The yield on 10-year U.S. Treasury notes, perhaps the world’s most influential interest rate, reached its highest since January 2025, briefly hitting 4.8 percent, and the yield on the 30-year bond continued to hover around a two-decade high. Yields move inversely to prices, so the rise in yields reflects a drop in prices.
America’s rising borrowing costs have set off a battle between Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and investors, but the factors pushing up bond yields in the United States are also issues in other big markets.
“It’s a global story,” said Peter Schaffrik, a strategist at RBC Capital Markets in London.
The rise in oil prices since the start of the war in Iran has compounded worries about stubbornly high inflation. Mr. Bessent is joining international finance ministers this week in Asheville, N.C., for a Group of 20 meeting, as U.S. foreign policy continues to upend the global economy. On Tuesday, he downplayed the market moves. “I don’t think we’re in any kind of dire situation,” he said in an interview with Fox Business at the meeting.
This week, the yield on 10-year bonds in Japan climbed above 3 percent for the first time since 1996; in Britain, they reached their highest level since mid-2007; and in Germany, they hit levels last seen in 2011.
A borrowing binge by technology companies to build artificial intelligence systems is another factor pushing up the costs of all types of debt. Companies have is-

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Secretive Supreme Court Keeps Its Own Records Close, if at All

By JODI KANTOR
In early 2016, Justice Antonin Scalia died suddenly of a heart attack on a Texas ranch, sending his Supreme Court colleagues into a period of grief and uncertainty. Behind closed doors, they had to contend with another piece of unsettling news.
Justice Scalia, the leading light of the conservative legal movement, had left no plans for his working papers, according to five people aware of the situation. For a Supreme Court justice, this was the equivalent of dying without a will. With no instructions for creating an archive or opening it to the public, the definitive inside account of his work — and the court’s — could be lost or emerge with uncomfortable speed.
So following his death, his colleagues entered into private negotiations to try to head off any such situation in the future.
In a series of memos and conference meetings, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. led the surviving justices in discussions about imposing a more uniform seal for their own papers, according to several people with knowledge of the process.
The absence of instructions from Justice Scalia and ensuing confidential conversations, which have not previously been reported, help explain why the nation’s highest court can be so difficult to understand. The ultimate record of the court’s work is considered the personal property of each justice, to dispose of or share as he or she chooses. And many of the justices have valued confiden-

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Conviction in Killing of Tupac
Duane Keith Davis, 63, was found guilty of first-degree murder after he went on an interview tour discussing his role in the 1996 drive-by shooting. PAGE A20

Having Second Thoughts
Gov. Josh Shapiro of Pennsylvania is pumping the brakes on data centers. But in a region that lost the steel industry, the jobs are welcome. PAGE A12

Details on Midtown Stabbing
The woman killed on her commute through Times Square on Monday was a young bank executive who was just back from maternity leave. PAGE A16

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U.S. and Iran Trade Strikes
The renewed hostilities were the latest surge of violence that has punctured weeks of relative calm. PAGE A10

Making Coffins as Ebola Rages
The virus has put makers at the center of a debate around how to bury still-contaminated bodies safely. PAGE A4



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John Ternus, Apple’s new C.E.O., faces big challenges to retain talent and innovate as A.I. reshapes tech. PAGE B1

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A Better Women’s Music Fest
Olivia Rodrigo successfully pulled off a resurrection of the genre with her Daisy Chain Fields event. PAGE C1

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Primaries in Massachusetts
Voters chose nominees for Senate and governor. Coverage at nytimes.com.

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Just Couldn’t Stay Away
The superb defensive lineman Aaron Donald was persuaded to end his retirement and return to the Rams by the team’s off-season moves, notably the trade for Myles Garrett. PAGE B7

The Billion-Dollar Wrist
After missing four weeks with the kind of injury that can doom a tennis career, Carlos Alcaraz won his first singles match at the United States Open in straight sets. PAGE B8

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Dinner? No Big Deal.
Ease into fall with weeknight meals that are truly delicious and ready in under an hour, like za’atar turkey meatballs with tahini yogurt, below. PAGE D4

